

Guideline - categorical

Categorical colors are not ordered.

Use these for categorical scales.

Do not use these for ordinal, interval, or ratio scales.

CATEGORICAL SCALE



Windows MacOS iOS All others

ORDINAL SCALE



Very Low Low Neutral All others

INTERVAL SCALE



1995 to 1999 2000 to 2004 2005 to 2009
2010 to 2014 2015 to 2020

RATIO SCALE



-10 to -5 -5 to 0 0 to 5 5 to 10
10 to 15

Guideline - many categories

Instead of giving each item a categorical color, encode them with **a secondary dimension** – ideally, one with few values.

An exception is when the chart is paired with other charts that use color for the same categories.

